

Turnstiles pick up small Russian change

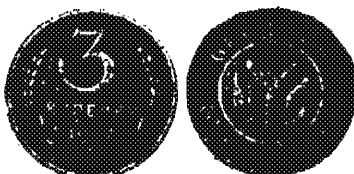
Who says the nickel subway ride has gone the way of the five-cent cigar?
Certainly not the Russians.

The friendly folks who brought you vodka, caviar and the 1980 Olympics now bring back the five-cent New York City subway ride—and threaten to turn the rush hour into the Russian hour.

The explanation is simple: The Soviet three-hopek coin, worth roughly a nickel, works perfectly in the subway turnstiles. It's the same size as the 60-cent token, although the token is a bit heavier.

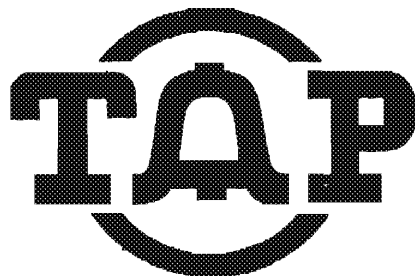
"Oh, no," Transit Authority spokesman Susan Gilbert sighed, adding that the authority isn't the least bit interested in bringing back the nickel fare—even Russian style—"unless we get established."

But the three-hopek piece still may not be a harbinger.



Soviet coin (1), worth about a nickel, is same size as 60-cent subway token and works in turnstiles.

It's hard to find here because the Soviet Union bans the export of its money. And one New York coin dealer is charging a buck each for them—at least for now.



TAP RAP by TOM EDISON

MAY-JUN 1981

NO. 67

And they say good things don't last! Congratulations TAP! It was ten years ago that Al Bell and Abbie Hoffman founded the Youth International Party Line or YIPL. They were at the 1971 May 1st anti-war rally in Washington, D.C. passing out leaflets asking people to join the Yippie movement. Thousands of leaflets were distributed and about one hundred people responded. The first issue of YIPL came out on June 1st, 1971. And the rest is history. There have been several name changes. YIPL changed to the Technological American Party or TAP in August of 1973 and in September of 1979 TAP became the Technological Assistance Program.

There have been several editors: Al Bell & Abbie Hoffman in 1971; Al Bell & R. Systat from 1972 to 1975; Al Bell, Jim Phelps, & Tom Edison from 1975 to 1977; and Tom Edison from 1977 to the present.

There have also been many good friends that have helped work on TAP over the years. I would be remiss in my duties as Editor-in-Chief of TAP if I did not thank them on our 10th anniversary. They are: Cheshire Catalyst, Dave Bowman, Jim Phelps, the Magician, the Wizard, Ted Vail, Number 6, Agent MDA, Oz Mandias, Joe Greyhound, Al Mundy, Al Token, Nikolai Testicle, Scotty, and last but certainly not least, Captain Crunch. Thanks guys!

You're probably all wondering what the hell happened to the color double edition of TAP that was promised. Well, I guess you could say that the Postal Monopoly has struck again! The large increase in postage rates has eaten up our reserves and the extra costs for printing and mailing a color double edition could not be absorbed by TAP this time. TAP also recently got a printer which compliments our computer system. This means that now TAP can print up our mailing labels on time. You bulk subscribers can't tell but all you first class subscribers please note the May 1st post mark on your envelopes. As I stated in the past, TAP will now be mailed like clockwork on January 1st, May 1st, and September 1st.

I would like to begin publishing on a monthly basis once again but that depends on YOU! I need more typed articles. TAP exists for the exchange and publication of interesting information that normally is not found anywhere else. It is my job as Editor to select the best submitted articles for publication. It is your job as a subscriber to write these articles. Don't complain to me if you didn't like an issue! I am not TAP! YOU ARE!!!

All articles MUST be typed on a good typewriter using a five inch type column width. All submitted articles become the property of TAP and cannot be returned. And if you don't know what kind of articles we're looking for, you have no business reading TAP!

High bidder on the last TAP copy of Abbie Hoffman's STEAL THIS BOOK was \$20.00 by Bob from Naukon, IA. Congratulations!

Our plans to publish THE BEST OF TAP have been temporarily shelved. We are still looking for a hip publisher. If anyone out there knows one, please get in touch with me.

I have tried to bite my tongue for the last few issues and hold off complaining to you subscribers out since our operations have been streamlined by our computer. I must impress upon you the importance of PRINTING your name & address CLEARLY, including your mailing label or a copy of it whenever you write to us about your sub, and sending in the right amount of money. Insufficient remittance will result in a pro-rated sub (You get only what you paid for). Please help us serve you!

Picking Mushrooms

By Al Mundy

In this article, I will attempt to bestow upon the reader an additional piece of infinitesimal wisdom in the realm of technological knowledge. I trust all of you TAP readers have been practicing your lock picking, because I will disclose in this article the method of picking a cylinder (lock) with mushroom drivers. A mushroom driver looks like the following, also illustrated is a spool driver. Both of these top pins perform the same function.



Mushroom Driver



Spool Driver

Corbin, Russwin, Abus, Walsaco, and American are some of the locks that contain mushroom pins. The Fox Police Lock Co. also uses a Russwin rim cylinder in its' products.

Now on to the technique. When one is confronted with a lock of this nature, one should pick the lock by first finding the bottom pin with the regular driver. There is usually only one regular top pin in a lock that contains mushroom drivers. But, the possibility exists that there may be more than one regular driver. While applying tension on the tension wrench, one picks the pins in the lock until one picks the one bottom pin with the regular driver. When the bottom pin with the regular driver reaches the sheer line in the lock, the plug will turn a fraction of a degree. At this point, one knows that you will have to pick the remaining bottom pins with the mushroom drivers. To push the bottom pin up to the sheer line, one will have to gradually release tension on the tension wrench as you are pushing up on the bottom pin. As you are pushing up on the bottom pin, you will feel the plug begin to lose that fraction of a degree to which the plug was turned. When the bottom pin has reached the sheer line, the plug will again turn a fraction of a degree. This will continue until all of the mushroom pins have been picked. At this time, the plug will be free to turn in the direction in which you have applied tension via the wrench.

One exception to this is two types of fairly new drivers which look as follows:



One should note the bottom lip of the pins.

One would pick these in the same manner. But, before the lock will open, one will have to release almost all tension on the wrench. This is because the bottom lip of the top pin is still in the plug preventing the lock from opening. While having almost no tension on the wrench, one will have to pick each bottom pin just a fraction more in order for the bottom pins to reach the sheer line.

GOOD LUCK AND KEEP ON TRYING!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!

So You Want To Get A Phone.

by Bill Bell

For those of you who still do not have a phone of your own I think I can help you. First off, flip through the white pages and find yourself a nice name.

Then call the person (for our example he will be Mr. John Dough) and say, "Mr. Dough, this is Mr. Bill of the Tallahassee business office and we would like to know how many extensions you have in your house." If they tell them it is for your records.

Then, after writing down all the important info, call your friendly neighbor and phone center store. Tell them that you are Mr. Dough and you wish to purchase an extension (or 2 or 3 or...) for your home. Tell them to add the charge to your phone bill and even set a date for the lineman to come and add the line. Then say you will come down to the store to pick up the phone. If you are young say that your son will pick it up. Be sure to tell them exactly what kind of phone(s) you want.

When you go to the phone center store, be sure to tell them to have all info like name, number, # of extensions, etc. as they may ask you a few questions when you get down there.

Pick it up, take off, and never show your face in that store again. Done correctly you can acquire a whole fleet of phones.

If you ever get questioned by Ma Bell (not my mother) about info on your phone just go to a Radio Shack and copy down the info off the bottom of one of their phones.

If you are in your teens or just look sorta young you may have to get yourself a cheap, fake I.D. Ma Bell is stupid, so it can be a really crummy one. Listen, \$7.00 is really cheap for a phone. (or 2 or 3 or...)

Be cool, calm and careful and whatever you do have that info memorized. John Dough is not going to stammer or stall when asked his phone number. HAVE FUN!!

FREE POSTAGE

by Bill Bell & Sam Junkins

In addition to putting glue on a stamp, lowering the stamp, etc. Here is another way to mail something for free. Go to any place that has non-profit bulk rate literature and pick yourself up a whole bunch of the stuff. Be sure only to get the envelopes, etc. that haven't been addressed yet. These envelopes or what have you are the things that places like museums, schools, libraries, etc., send out.

First type the address of the person you are sending it to or very neatly print it.

Then, write the letter on 1 or 2 sheets of paper and insert them inside the literature fold it a seal it with a single staple.

Be sure your friend won't throw your letter away as junk mail.

Be sure not to send anything to TAP this way as it is illegal and we would not want to deprive our friend, the Post Office, any money that it has coming to it, would we?



= 36¢ =

Post Office giving out mail orders

The Post Office is going to make one more attempt to see that people deliver their mail correctly. If this fails, it's going to have to turn to drastic measures.

We are informed of this by a relative who works in the Post Office and said the PO was losing patience with its customers. "We've done everything we could to make life easier for the customer. We've raised the rates of first-class mail, we've given everyone a five-day ZIP code, we've put up instructions on the size and shape of the envelopes, and still the mail is late. We have no choice but to take stronger steps to prevent the system."

"Here's that!" I asked.

"We're going to up the price of first-class stamps to 10 cents, and update the five-day ZIP code. In that way, the customer will know we really mean business."

"I'm not too clear how raising the price of the stamps and adding a five-day ZIP code is going to help. Most people have trouble understanding a five-day number."

"We have to make the customer realize when he makes a letter, he has a responsibility for getting it to the other end. He can no longer just dump it in a mailbox and expect the Post Office to do all the work for him. We've tried to be sure about it in the past, but we've not been able to force it more strongly. So we've taken the next step. The letter-bearing is either yours or ours."

The other customer for the letter.

Two new scans have been attempted on us in the past couple months. We did not fall for either.

One is the fake letterhead deal by which one asks for samples of our product with a promise of buying large quantities for gifts, sales incentives, etc. The firm name is usually very impressive, some even give an overseas branch address (1). It's easy to get letterheads printed up. The fancier, the better. But when someone asks for a sample of our products and we are not familiar with the firm, we call the Ma Bell op and see if there is a phone listed for the outfit. If it's real, biggie sounding firm, we look him up in one of the many directories available at the library. I doubt if many people go to this trouble before sending samples, etc. but we operate on such a small margin we have more time than we have money. I'm sure this scam would work with most big companies to whom you wrote. Even if they didn't give you samples, they would probably send them and bill you.

The other scam involves fake checks. I don't know how one gets the checks unless he gets samples from a bank stationery printer. We have received what look like legitimate checks but when they are presented there is no record of the person or the account. Apparently the con artist has someone imprint his fake name and some "computer" numbers on the checks. Being an old quack expert at crypto we have been able to "see through" many of the fictitious names. Some are as dumb as to spell their names backwards even when they don't make sense. One con from the west coast uses the name Norwairf and Adnan. Turned out to be Harlan Ann Peterson and she didn't fool us. She must be a beginner at this!

I feel sure no TAP reader would attempt one of these scams; this info is given so you can catch anyone who tries to pull one of them on you.

Jailhouse story

BARCELONA (Reuters) - Courts at Barcelona's central prison became so noisy when guards carefully listening plants in the kitchen garden. They turned out to be earphones plants, 100 square feet of them, according to prison officials.



ships up or ship out."

"So you believe by taking a hard line, the Post Office service will improve?"

"If the five-day ZIP code doesn't do it, we hope people up, we have a contingency plan that will change the entire system."

"What's that?" I asked.

"We're going to make the customer deliver his own mail."

"Here are you going to do that?"

"I will go something like this. After a person writes a letter, he will take it down to the post office and have the stamp cancelled. Then he will proceed the addresser's house and drop his mailbox. If he wants to get it there fast, he can take a taxi. If he isn't in a hurry, he can take the bus or subway, or even walk. If there are no transportation modes as near as our delivery routes, he can take a taxi."

"I understand that would sound things up in the same corner. But suppose someone in Louisville is sending a letter to someone in California. That wouldn't work very well for him."

"The idea is to make for him. The

person in Louisville would deliver someone else's letter from California to someone in Louisville, and the person in Louisville would deliver the Louisville letter in the period 10 the town in which he lived. For example, if you were writing to your Aunt Flora in Baraboo, you would go to the post office and after the stamp on the letter was cancelled, you would pack up a letter to your Aunt Flora. Someone in Baraboo who was sending a check to someone in Maryland would get it to your Aunt Flora.

"That sounds like a great idea. I said, 'Through that of likes or dark of night the customer will get your mail to you. If that plan goes through, you'll be able to lower the price of a postage stamp and eliminate the ZIP code!'"

"No, we'll have to raise the postal rate to 20 cents, because we'll have to have more people to sort that the customer delivers the mail properly. Also, we have to keep the new ZIP code to work. The only advantage of the new system will be the customer will be in control with the mail service, and will understand how difficult it is to get a letter to where it's addressed."

"But the customer will have to deliver just mail!"

"Certainly not. There will be much to be done in the house of delivery when we are around in our business."

Pol bell bill quite phony

State Senate Majority Leader John F. Baines heard something was wrong when he and telephone bills for \$1,000, about \$800 more than usual.

He said the bills were for the Burlington County Jail and the Burlington Reformatory managed to charge \$7,428 in monthly calls to Baines' credit card number, he said last week.

Company fails to probe

Peter Hoffman, a spokesman for New Jersey Telephone, said he would make an attempt to find out who made the 3,200 calls, but they have not been identified.

He said he had destroyed the credit card numbers used in the calls, but he had not destroyed the credit card numbers used in the calls.

He said New Jersey Bell told him that people sometimes try different numbers at night, but if they do on one that works, they continue to use it.

Hoffman said New Jersey Bell had not been able to find out who made the calls, but he said the calls are not for the phone company, nor are they for the phone company.

Ma Bell gets her bell rung

Money might not buy happiness but it did brought a lot of satisfaction to Joseph Norwairf of Jersey City. It wasn't the amount but rather the way in which Norwairf received his money. The 25-year-old Jersey City Reformatory Agency worker is believed to be the first person in New Jersey to be awarded damages for time lost while waiting for a phone repair crew that never showed.

Norwairf said he was awarded \$1,000 in damages for work he lost while he was waiting for a phone repair crew that never showed. He said he was awarded \$1,000 in damages for work he lost while he was waiting for a phone repair crew that never showed.

Both sides presented conflicting accounts of what happened. Norwairf claimed the phone company broke a promise to repair his phone within 24 hours. The phone company claimed Norwairf was the culprit.

A phone company spokesman said an appeal to be held. "Obviously, a settlement of the dispute is being claimed in his letter that a new Norwairf decision would open 'Pardon's law.'"

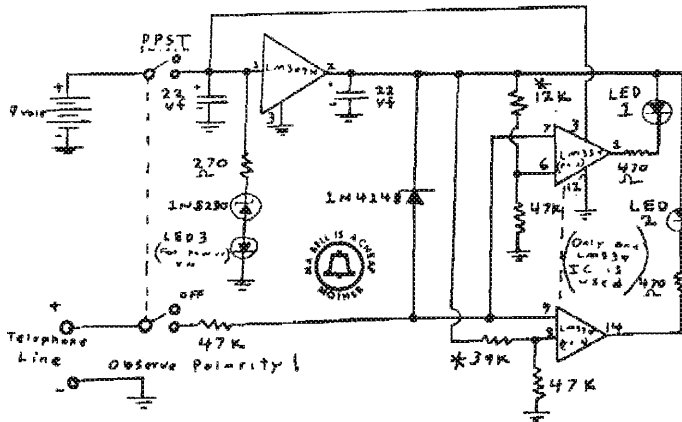
By The Magician...

Send any questions, comments etc. to
THE MAGICIAN C/O TAP

But NTT lawyers concede that they have not been able to pinpoint the source of the leaks. They say the company's internal security is so tight that it is unlikely that anyone would be able to steal the company's secrets. They say the company's internal security is so tight that it is unlikely that anyone would be able to steal the company's secrets.

Those missions, and other opportunities in the country, broadcast up to 24 hours a day in French and Spanish. Line ads also are broadcast on television, at least twice

Calculated another way, the average worker spends two hours and 28 minutes at work each day in pay idle time. After that, he's working for himself.



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